

China's tech giants open source agentic AI frameworks to challenge US AI dominance

China's leading technology companies are accelerating innovation in artificial intelligence by open sourcing agentic frameworks, the software platforms required to build and manage AI agents, directly challenging US players such as AutoGen and OpenAI Swarm.

Tencent Holdings has open sourced its new Youtu-Agent framework. Developed by Youtu Labs, the company's AI research department, the framework has been released on Microsoft's open source code-hosting platform GitHub. Tencent said its approach would "simplify the agent configuration process."

Youtu-Agent built on the open source DeepSeek-V3.1 model achieved a benchmark score of 71.47 per cent on WebWalkerQA, a test for web traversal tasks.

This release follows earlier similar moves by Tencent's domestic rivals. In July, ByteDance, the owner of TikTok, open sourced its agent development platform Coze Studio. In March, Alibaba Group Holding made its Qwen-Agent framework open source.

Agentic frameworks are critical enablers for AI systems that can autonomously plan and execute subtasks to complete complex missions. Examples include Chinese start-up Butterfly Effect's Manus and OpenAI's Operator.

By making these frameworks open source, Chinese tech giants are not only showcasing technical capability but also aiming to democratise access, set global benchmarks, and drive adoption of their tools. Tencent's GitHub release highlights the country's broader strategy: harnessing open source collaboration to strengthen its AI position against US counterparts.

decision follows an overwhelming influx of applications that created "limited capacity to pursue new strategic opportunities," the foundation said in a recent blog post.



analytics, research, and education. In just the first quarter of 2025, \$32.6 million in grants were distributed.

Founded in 2014 by Ethereum's co-founders, the foundation has played a central role in funding blockchain development and coordinating major network upgrades. In June 2025, it introduced a transparent treasury policy, committing to publish quarterly and annual disclosures of its assets, investments, and operational costs.

Looking ahead, the foundation is steering Ethereum towards a renewed focus on layer-1 scaling, lowering network costs, and improving user experience.

Earlier this year, the foundation launched a \$1 trillion security initiative to strengthen Ethereum's resilience and expand its appeal to a broader audience beyond crypto.

Despite competition from Solana, Avalanche, and BNB Smart Chain, Ethereum remains the dominant open source smart contract platform, with \$91.5 billion in total value locked across DeFi, according to DefiLlama.

Version 2.0 of Crossplane released

The Crossplane open source project has released version 2.0, marking a pivotal expansion from managing only cloud infrastructure to orchestrating both applications and infrastructure. With this upgrade, platform teams can now deploy



an application and all its required infrastructure through a single YAML manifest, blurring the lines between deployment and provisioning.

Key architectural enhancements define this release.

Compositions can now include any Kubernetes resource, enabling unified abstractions that cover databases, networking, applications, and monitoring. A new namespace-first approach aligns with Kubernetes conventions, improving multi-tenancy, reducing duplication, and enhancing access control. AWS is fully supported at launch, with Azure, GCP, and Terraform updates in progress. Crossplane 2.0 also introduces declarative 'Operations' for one-off tasks, upgrades, and event-driven processes, alongside selective managed resource installation to prevent CRD overload.

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